“Tech Has Outrun Politics.” Nobody has assessed the risks and benefits involved in using new technologies against allies and friends. There is a need for new leadership, top-down reform, and legislation. If this is not done, the NSA could turn the United States into a totalitarian regime.

Do we want to live in a world where at any given moment we can become transparent and exposed to both enemies and friends? Where technological capabilities are operated by technocrats and robots, before any proper staff work has been carried out by political decision makers? Where the threat of annihilation hangs over our heads, and if and when it happens, heaven forbid, we won’t even be able to identify the enemy that pulled the virtual trigger?

I, for one, do not want to live in a world like this. I am told that the “next big thing” is quantum communication, which has already passed the stage of practicability. I am told that this technology is the antidote to cyberattacks. My hope is that this type of communication will not add transparency to our world but will bring it back to what it was—a world in which our privacy is preserved.